2013 Toyota Corolla (salvage title)

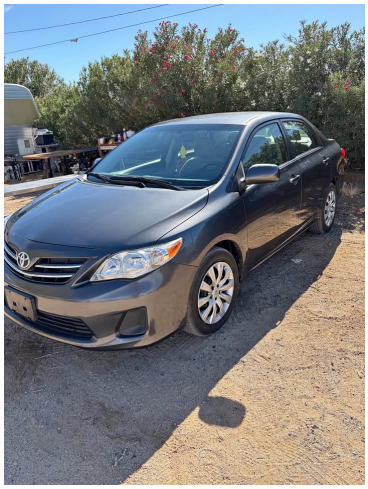
$7,200 · 120,414 miles · Private seller · Ridgecrest, CA

Seller: Private seller

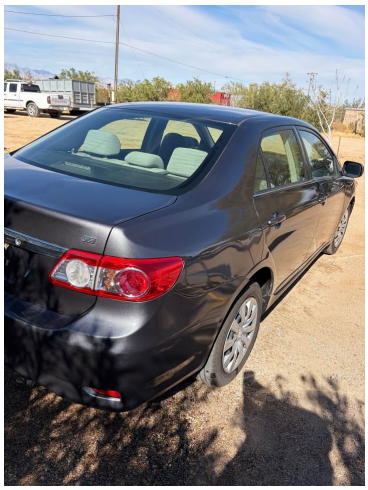
Source: Facebook Marketplace

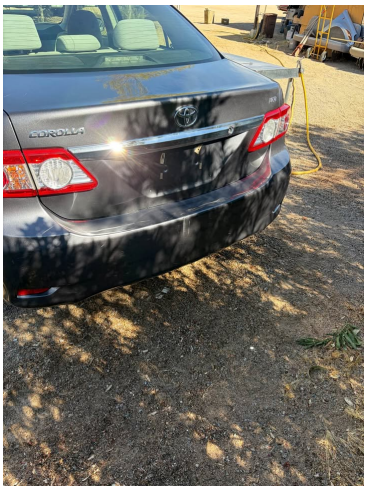
Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/1736843237388414/

Report generated October 30, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 2 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$8,101	**$502**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 5 recalls · 201 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$7,200.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$666.00
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$46.80
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$8,100.80
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$3,100.80
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$62.13
Total interest over the loan	$627.22
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$62.13
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 30 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$158.33
Maintenance & repair reserve	$130.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$16.40
Total per month	$501.87

Running costs without the loan: **$440/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$13,742** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

2013 Corolla 1.8 (2ZR-FE) with the 4-speed automatic is one of the most durable cheap commuters. The salvage title is the main risk: unknown frame or airbag repair, harder to insure full-coverage, lower resale.

NHTSA data for this model year: 5 recalls · 201 owner complaints (46 involving a crash). Most complaints: Air Bags (72), Steering (39), Service Brakes (24), Vehicle Speed Control (18), Engine (16), Unknown Or Other (15).

Known issues for this model

• Salvage title: damage and repair quality unknown

• Some 2ZR engines burn oil past 150k

• Water pump weep around 100–150k

• 4-speed auto, highway rpm is high

Check on this car before buying

• Get VIN, run Copart/IAAI and NHTSA recalls

• Inspect frame rails, airbag lights, panel gaps

• Check oil level and color

• Confirm the smog certificate and title paperwork

Notes

Added 2026-10-30. Listed 10/29. Automatic 1.8L, 120k mi, SALVAGE title, smog passed, tires good. Seller is a Ridgecrest repair shop with 21 good reviews. $7,200 is high for a salvage car: a clean-title 2013 Corolla with 120k is about $8–9k, and salvage usually sells 20–40% under clean. Offer about $5,500. Ask for the VIN and what the damage was, then check Copart/IAAI history and get the $185 Toyota of Ridgecrest inspection like the Prius.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.